Date	31 January 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Global Fuel Prices and Taxation Analysis (2020–2026)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Ideation Phase
Empathize & Discover

Empathy Map Canvas:
An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviors and attitudes. It is a useful tool to help teams better understand their users.

Creating an effective solution requires understanding the true problem and the person who is experiencing it. The exercise of creating the map helps participants consider things from the user's perspective along with his or her goals and challenges across our three key operational profiles: Policy Research, Supply Chain Logistics, and Energy Economics.

Included User Persona Canvases:

- **Page 2: Dr. Sarah Mitchell** – Policy Consultant at a Global Energy Institute (Scenario 1)
- **Page 3: Marcus Thompson** – Supply Chain Director at a Global Freight Corporation (Scenario 2)
- **Page 4: Prof. Elena Rodriguez** – Energy Economics Researcher (Scenario 3)

SAYS

- "Which countries apply the highest tax percentage on retail petrol and diesel?"
- "Where are fuel subsidies heaviest, and how do they impact net retail prices?"
- "I need clear international policy benchmarks to advise governments on fiscal reform."

THINKS

- Which regions achieve carbon reduction goals through heavy fuel excise taxes?
- Are subsidies distorting true energy market pricing in developing economies?
- Scattered government reports make international policy comparison slow and unreliable.

DR. SARAH MITCHELL
(Policy Consultant)

DOES

- Analyzes global tax heatmaps and fuel price structures across 84 countries.
- Evaluates net tax vs subsidy impacts on consumer fuel expenditure.
- Presents evidence-based energy policy briefs to government ministries.

FEELS

- Pressured to deliver accurate fiscal recommendations to policymakers.
- Frustrated when tax datasets use mismatched metrics or currencies.
- Confident when policy insights are supported by clear visual analytics.

SAYS

- "Which global transit routes are facing the highest diesel price spikes?"
- "What is the forecasted trend for fuel prices over the next two quarters?"
- "Our fleet managers need reliable price forecasts to mitigate operational cost risks."

THINKS

- How can we hedge fuel supply contracts in high-volatility regions?
- Should we reroute transport fleets to countries with stabilized fuel pricing?
- Static price charts don't help when fuel rates fluctuate week to week.

MARCUS THOMPSON
(Supply Chain Director)

DOES

- Tracks diesel and petrol retail trends across primary logistics corridors.
- Calculates regional fuel price volatility indices for freight budgeting.
- Utilizes predictive forecasting models to adjust transportation surcharges.

FEELS

- Anxious about unpredicted crude price surges eating into operating margins.
- Stressed by decentralized pricing data across regional fuel suppliers.
- Reassured when predictive logistics models show low forecast variance.

PROF. ELENA RODRIGUEZ
(Energy Economist)

SAYS

- "How strongly do Brent crude spot price fluctuations pass through to retail fuel rates?"
- "How does fuel tax burden vary relative to a nation's income-level classification?"
- "Academic publications demand rigorous cross-tabulations and long-term trend data."

THINKS

- Are lower-income nations disproportionately burdened by retail fuel taxes?
- What is the lag time between crude market shifts and consumer pump price adjustments?
- Manual econometrics across 27,000+ data points is tedious without unified tooling.

DOES

- Runs correlation models comparing Brent Crude prices to retail Petrol and LPG.
- Cross-tabulates fuel subsidies against World Bank national income tiers.
- Publishes academic studies on international energy market dynamics.

FEELS

- Driven by scientific curiosity to uncover macroeconomic fuel price patterns.
- Constrained by fragmented datasets requiring endless manual preprocessing.
- Fulfilled when econometric models reveal clear structural insights.